Table rule – alcohol resistance (Constitution) · SRD 5.2.1 contains **no intoxication rule**; this sheet builds on the Poisoned condition and the SRD's poison protections.

Drinking more than your body can take is played with **Constitution**. Everyone has a **tolerance** of **2 + Constitution modifier** drinks (minimum 1). Beyond it, **each drink** needs a **Constitution save** whose DC rises with each extra drink. A failure gives one **intoxication level**.

Intoxication mimics the **Poisoned** condition: anything in the SRD that protects against poison (Dwarven Resilience, Antitoxin, *Protection from Poison*) **also helps** hold your liquor.

🎲 Quick summary:

1. Tolerance: **2 + Con mod.** drinks (min. 1).
2. Beyond it: **Con save DC 10 + extra drinks**.
3. Failure: **+1 intoxication level** (3 levels max).
4. Poison protections: **Advantage** on the save.

⚠ Change from 2014

SRD 2024 has no intoxication rule; only the Poisoned condition, poison resistance and a few spells come close. Nothing has changed since 2014 here.

⚠ Flaw in the rule and fixes Table rule

With no official rule, every table improvises. Fix: set the tolerance and DC before the evening and announce intoxication levels.

💡 Narrative option: Table rule

The DM can describe the drunkenness (laughter, blurry gaze, loose legs) before announcing the level reached.

Step 1 – Count the drinks:

One drink = a mug of beer or a glass of wine. A spirit counts as **2 drinks**; a very light drink as **½ drink**.

Step 2 – Tolerance:

Up to 2 + Constitution modifier drinks: no roll.

Step 3 – Constitution save:

Each drink beyond: DC 10 + the number of drinks already had beyond tolerance. Advantage with a poison protection.

Step 4 – Intoxication level:

Failure: +1 level (Tipsy, Drunk, Passed Out).

Step 5 – Recover:

One hour without drinking: remove 1 drink from the count. Short Rest: −1 level. Long Rest: back to zero, but a hangover if level 2 was reached.

Example: Brann (Con +3) tolerates 5 drinks. On the 7th drink, DC 10 + 2 = 12: he rolls 9, he's Tipsy. On the 8th, DC 13: he rolls 14, he holds.

Level	Name	Effects
0	Sober	No effect.
1	Tipsy	Advantage on saves against fear; Disadvantage on Wisdom (Perception) and Intelligence checks.
2	Drunk	Poisoned (Disadvantage on attacks and ability checks); slurred speech: Disadvantage on Persuasion.
3	Passed Out	Unconscious 1d4 hours (wakes on damage); hangover on waking.
–	Hangover	After level 2: Disadvantage on Intelligence checks until a Long Rest.

Drinking contest (opposed)

Round	Constitution DC	Rule
1	10	Each contestant drinks one.
2	12	+2 per round.
3	14	First to fail: loses; tie: both lose a level.
4+	+2 per round	One intoxication level per failure; 3 levels = unconscious.

⚠ Common questions:

Is there an official rule?

No: the SRD has no intoxication rule. This is a table rule.

Which ability?

Constitution: tolerance and saving throws.

Is alcohol a poison?

Not in the SRD; here intoxication mimics the Poisoned condition.

What is the Poisoned condition?

Disadvantage on attack rolls and ability checks.

What does a dwarf protect against?

Poison damage resistance and Advantage on saves against Poisoned: here, Advantage on intoxication saves.

Does Antitoxin help?

It gives Advantage on saves against poison for 1 hour: here, on intoxication saves.

What does Lesser Restoration cure?

It ends the Poisoned condition: here, it removes one intoxication level.

⚠ Debate points and table options:

Table rule

Alcohol = poison?

Treat alcohol as poison for Advantage.
Option: yes, this sheet's choice.

Save per drink or per hour

A save per drink beyond tolerance.
Option: one save per hour with rising DC.

Death?

A lethal intoxication doesn't exist here.
Option: level 3 = unconsciousness only.

DM's role

Very strong drinks (dwarven spirits).
Option: count ×3 drinks.

⚠ Rule clarifications (answers found on the web, reworded):

Drinking contest

Tables use opposed Constitution saves; the first to fail loses. The DC rises each round.

Cheating

Using magic or a magic item against alcohol is considered cheating in a contest.

Strong drinks

A very strong drink often counts double or triple.

Recovery

Sleep and food help: Long Rest = reset to zero.

These points remain open to discussion: your feedback is welcome to refine this sheet.

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